

WELCOME TO THE DISCWORLD

A quick primer for players new to Terry Pratchett's world

TONE: dry, sarcastic, full of puns. Common sense is rare, so be polite to anyone carrying an axe, and never ask what's in the sausage.

THE DISC

A flat world, balanced on the backs of **four elephants**, who stand on the shell of a giant turtle (**Great A'Tuin**) swimming through space. Everyone here thinks this is perfectly normal. It's fantasy, but with the clichés poked until they squeak.

- **Narrative Causality:** stories *want* to happen. One-in-a-million chances come up nine times out of ten, and the funnier or more dramatic option usually wins. Lean in.
- **Magic is real and can do anything, but should it?** If it results in something interesting it will probably cooperate, but never without some sort of mishap. Clever wizards quickly learn to use it only in times of need.
- **Directions:** there's no north or south. Travel is **hubwards** (toward the Disc's centre), **rimwards** (toward the edge), **turnwise** (with the Disc's spin) or **widdershins** (against it).
- **Belief is power.** Gods, ideas and monsters exist because enough people believe in them.

ANKH-MORPORK

The biggest, smelliest, most cosmopolitan city on the Disc, and the home of nearly everyone you'll play. Sits on the **River Ankh**, so polluted it's crunchy, and you can almost walk across. Every species lives here, and gets along because everyone is equally mistrusted.

- **Lord Vetinari, the Patrician**, rules the city: a thin, calm, terrifying tyrant who is both feared *and* respected, and who somehow keeps the whole mess running. You do not want him to take an interest in you.
- **The Guilds run everything.** Rather than fight crime, the city regulates it:
 - **Thieves:** licensed, with a yearly quota. Pay your dues and you get a receipt, and nobody else will rob you.
 - **Assassins:** gentlemen and ladies of taste, with a dress code and rules of engagement. Murder is a profession like any other.
 - **Beggars:** licensed pitches and a strict pecking order. Don't even *think* of poaching a corner.
 - **Fools:** clowns and jesters, professionally trained. Funnier than they look, and pies are serious business.
 - **Seamstresses:** not to be confused with "needlewomen" (those who actually mend textiles). The guild instead provides ladies of negotiable affection.
- **The City Watch** is run by **Commander Vimes** and recruits from every species in the city. The members range from sharp to sleepy, and they're underfunded and rarely taken seriously (except by the criminals).
- **Unseen University** is where the wizards live, eat enormous meals, and are carefully ignored. The Librarian is an orangutan.



Drawn by Matt Smith

YOU ARE A TROLL

- **What you are:** a silicon-based life form, literally made of rock (granite, flint, marble, coal...), and you look like whatever you were born from. You grow from a pebble to the size of a small hill, and the older you get, the slower you think.
- **Heat vs. cold:** your brain is impure silicon that overheats. In hot Ankh-Morpork you're *slow and dim* (counting past "many" is a stretch). In extreme heat or strong sun your brain shuts down, which is where "trolls turn to stone in daylight" comes from. In the **cold** you're *sharp and clever*, peaking just above the temperature that would freeze you solid. An ice pack on the head works wonders.
- **Body:** immensely strong, diamond teeth, and you wear nothing much beyond a coat of lichen. You eat rock and minerals (gems are the good stuff) and drink molten minerals such as sulphur, which hits you the way a pint hits a human.
- **Culture:** many trolls come down from the cold High Ramtops hoping to make something of themselves, and their dreams melt on the way. Trolls and dwarfs have a long, ugly history, so tread carefully.
- **Stereotypes:** *simple, blunt, loyal and strong*. Speaks in short sentences, offers an occasional "Right!", and is pleasantly surprised by the clever ideas that arrive when it gets cold.
- **Names:** after rock: Flint, Ruby, Detritus, Chrysoprase, Coalface, Brick, Schist, Chalky.